

the first State object declared in the states property (an array). Flex state names cannot include periods, spaces, or other special characters. This ensures that the code used in MXML declarations to set attributes for particular states is syntactically correct. For example, this Label is only bold in a state named “boldState”:

- `<s:Label text="Hello world" fontWeight.boldState="bold"/>`

If the state name were allowed to be set as “bold.State” (with the period), the code to set the property would be:

- `<s:Label text="Hello world" fontWeight.bold.State="bold"/>`

The parser would fail on this declaration.

Defining View States in Design View

Flash Builder has a States view that shows up by default only when the Flex Development perspective is active and the current application or component is being edited in Design view, the States view has a toolbar that includes the buttons New State, Duplicate State, Edit State and Delete State

You can create a new view state by clicking the New State button on the toolbar, or by right-clicking in the States view and selecting New State from the context menu. The New State dialog box, asks for the properties,

- ▶ **Name** - A non-blank String value is required.
- ▶ **Duplicate of** - This asks which state the new view state is based on.
- ▶ **Blank State** - This selection results in the removal of any existing visual objects from the new state. You can easily change this in the code after the state has been created.
- ▶ **Set as start state** - This check box enables you to assign the new state as the application or component’s starting state upon instantiation.

Defining a view state’s overrides

To define a view state’s override actions in Design view, first select the appropriate view state from the States view or the State selector. Then make changes to the Application or component with these design time actions:

- ▶ Add components to the state by dragging from the Components view.
- ▶ Remove components by selecting and deleting them.
- ▶ Change components’ properties and styles through the Flex Properties view.
- ▶ Change event handlers through the Flex Properties view.

You can select the current view state either from the States view or, from the view state selection menu in the Design view editor toolbar. When working with an application or component whose width or height exceeds the available dimen-